

3.1.8 Area of study 7: Art music since 1910

For the purpose of this specification art music since 1910 is defined as music that comprises modern, contemporary classical, electronic art, experimental and minimalist music as well as other forms.

Named composers

- Dmitri Shostakovich
- Olivier Messiaen
- Steve Reich
- James MacMillan

Musical elements

The following table contains all the musical elements, for this area of study, that students must know and understand to answer questions in section A (Listening) and section C (Essay) of the exam. Marks will also be awarded for knowledge of other terms, if relevant to this area of study, in section C (Essay) of the exam.

Element type	Element
Melody	• modes of limited transposition (including whole tone and octatonic scales) • pentatonic and hexatonic scales • tone row • note addition and subtraction • resultant melody • cells and motifs • metamorphosis.
Harmony	• non-functional harmony • chord extensions eg added 6th • cluster chords • static harmony • open fifths.
Tonality	• bitonality • tonal ambiguity • atonality • modality.
Structure	• cyclical structures • ostinato • cadenza.
Sonority (Timbre)	• organ stops eg reeds, mixtures, use of swell pedal, tremulant • studio effects eg reverb, sampling • unusual instruments eg ondes Martenot • unusual effects eg col legno, harmonics.
Texture	• looping • layering • a cappella • drones.
Tempo, metre and rhythm	• additive rhythms • palindromic rhythms • metrical displacement • phasing • augmentation and diminution.